

POL-BIZ-003 - Seller Onboarding and Account Readiness Policy

Policy | Business

Document ID	POL-BIZ-003	Seller ID	Organization-wide
Department	Business	Classification	INTERNAL
Owner	Aditya Verma	Created Date	2026-07-24
Version	2.3	Effective Date	2026-07-24
Related Scenario ID	SC-009	Document Type	Policy

1. Purpose

This policy defines the conditions a seller must satisfy before being activated on Nexora Marketplace, the readiness conditions attached to commercial entitlements, and the mechanism by which an exception to those conditions may be granted.

It exists to ensure that commercial commitments made to a seller are supported by the seller's actual operational and technical readiness, and that any departure from that principle is deliberate, bounded and owned.

2. Scope

Applies to all new seller accounts and to any material change of integration method on an existing account.

Applies to changes in settlement frequency, tier and commercial terms on an existing account, insofar as those changes carry readiness conditions.

Does not apply to catalogue expansion, pricing changes or routine operational changes on an already-active account.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Activation	The point at which a seller's listings become buyable
Readiness condition	A verifiable condition attached to a commercial entitlement
Milestone	A readiness condition with a defined validator and date
Compensating control	A measure that bounds risk where a condition is unmet
Policy exception	A documented, time-bound departure from a stated condition
Closure standard	The evidence required to consider a condition satisfied
Two-stage onboarding	Activation on an interim process with a committed migration

4. Activation Conditions

A seller may not be activated unless all of the following are satisfied.

ID	Condition	Verified by
A-1	Commercial agreement signed and countersigned	Business
A-2	KYC and entity verification complete	Operations
A-3	Category-specific compliance verified where applicable	Operations
A-4	Category and commission mapping agreed	Business
A-5	Named seller counterpart recorded	Business
A-6	Integration method selected with recorded rationale	Engineering
A-7	Sandbox authentication demonstrated	Engineering
A-8	Catalogue validation completed; failing records withheld	Operations
A-9	Tax category mapping resolves explicitly for every listing	Operations
A-10	Fulfilment nodes or logistics partners verified	Operations
A-11	Label generation failover tested live	Operations
A-12	Pilot completed with findings recorded	Operations
A-13	Support queue readiness confirmed	Support

R-1. Conditions A-1 through A-13 are cumulative. None may be satisfied by assertion; each requires evidence meeting the closure standard in section 6.

R-2. Category compliance under A-3 must be on file before catalogue preparation begins, not before activation.

R-3. Where catalogue records fail validation, withholding the record is preferred to publishing it with poor data. Catalogue size is not an activation criterion.

5. Readiness Conditions for Commercial Entitlements

Certain commercial entitlements carry readiness conditions independent of tier.

5.1 Weekly Settlement

ID	Condition	Validator
W-1	Six consecutive settlement cycles with no dispute	Settlement desk
W-2	Automated order and refund reconciliation at the seller	Operations
W-3	Verified failover for fulfilment-critical integrations, live-tested	Operations
W-4	Dispute rate below the category threshold for two quarters	Business

R-4. All four conditions must be met. Tier alone does not confer weekly settlement.

R-5. Any settlement dispute resets W-1 to zero.

The seller portal describes weekly settlement as a tier feature without stating these conditions. That discrepancy was raised in January 2026 and is a known documentation gap on the seller-facing side. Until it is corrected, account managers should state the conditions explicitly when a seller raises the subject.

5.2 Tier Upgrade

R-6. Tier is reviewed annually, or on milestone completion where a conditional upgrade is in effect.

R-7. Tier may be reviewed downward where order defect rate exceeds the tier threshold for two consecutive months.

R-8. Tier and settlement frequency are separable. A tier upgrade may be granted where a settlement frequency change may not, because the two carry different and asymmetric risks: a tier change is commercially reversible at the next review, whereas settlement frequency determines how much unreconciled value is paid out before a dispute could surface.

6. Closure Standard

R-9. A condition is satisfied by evidence that the thing works, not by evidence that it has been configured.

Condition type	Acceptable evidence
Failover configuration	A successful live failover test
Monitoring or alerting	The alert observed firing in a controlled test
Data quality rule	A rejection report showing the rule acting
Interim process removal	The interim process confirmed retired
Seller-side capability	Confirmation from the named seller counterpart
Reconciliation capability	A reconciliation run compared against platform figures

R-10. A configuration entry, a ticket marked complete, or a verbal assurance is not acceptable closure evidence for any condition in section 4 or 5.

Rule R-9 was added in July 2026. A failover condition had been closed in October 2025 on a configuration entry; when the failover was required eight months later, the stored credentials had expired and no label could be generated for 2,100 perishable orders. The condition had been recorded as met and had never been true.

7. Exceptions

R-11. An exception to any condition in sections 4 or 5 requires all of the following:

1. A written rationale stating what is being waived and why.
2. A named approver with authority for the affected domain.
3. A compensating control that bounds the resulting risk.
4. Milestones with named validators where the condition is deferred rather than waived.
5. An expiry date, after which the exception lapses and the entitlement is withdrawn.

R-12. An exception may not waive A-2 (KYC), A-3 (category compliance) or A-9 (tax mapping). These are compliance conditions, not commercial ones.

R-13. Two-stage onboarding is permitted where an interim process is used at activation, provided the exception carries an explicit exit date. An open-ended commitment to migrate is not an acceptable exception; in practice it becomes permanent.

R-14. A compensating control must be proportionate to the exposure it bounds, and must be sized against the risk rather than against the seller's convenience. A security deposit, for example, is sized against the largest single-cycle dispute observed on comparable accounts.

R-15. Every active exception is reviewed at each quarterly account review.

7.1 Worked Example

A grocery seller requested a tier upgrade and weekly settlement in January 2026, having completed four settlement cycles, with no automated reconciliation and an untested failover.

The tier upgrade was granted immediately, because tier risk is commercially reversible. Weekly settlement was deferred and tied to validation of the reconciliation milestone, with a security deposit as the compensating control and an expiry date of 31 January 2027.

Three of four milestones were subsequently met. The reconciliation milestone remains outstanding as of September 2026, and weekly settlement has accordingly not been granted. The exception is operating as intended: the commercial benefit was delivered where it was safe to do so, and the financial control held.

8. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Business	Commercial configuration, exception approval, tier decisions
Operations	Execution of onboarding, condition verification, closure decisions
Engineering	Integration provisioning, technical validation
Support	Queue readiness, early ticket handling
IT	Credential issuance, access configuration, rotation enrolment
Seller counterpart	Seller-side readiness and confirmation

R-16. Operations owns the go or no-go decision at each stage. Business owns the commercial consequences of a delay. Where these conflict, the conflict is escalated for a documented decision and is not resolved by weakening a condition.

9. Escalation

Situation	Escalate to	Timeframe
Condition unmet and activation date at risk	Business and Operations jointly	1 working day
Compliance condition cannot be satisfied	Operations lead; halt onboarding	Immediately
Seller requests terms outside policy	Business, as an exception request	2 working days
Exception approaching expiry with milestone unmet	Business	30 days before expiry
Closure evidence does not meet the standard	Operations lead	Before closure

10. Enforcement

Activation is gated in the account management system on conditions A-1 through A-13 being recorded as satisfied. Weekly settlement is gated on milestone validation.

Exceptions without an expiry date are rejected by the exception record.

Quarterly account reviews test every active exception. An exception past expiry with an unmet milestone results in withdrawal of the entitlement, which is a system action rather than a negotiation.

11. Review History

Version	Date	Change	Owner
1.0	2022-03-02	Initial onboarding policy	Business
2.0	2025-04-18	Readiness conditions separated from tier	Aditya Verma
2.1	2026-01-28	Exception mechanism formalised with compensating controls	Aditya Verma
2.2	2026-06-20	Separate staging and production credentials required	Aditya Verma
2.3	2026-07-24	Closure standard added; failover requires a live test	Aditya Verma

Next scheduled review: July 2027.